ECONOMIC CULTURES · MODULE 2

FROM QUOTE TO INVOICE

How do you ask to be paid?



a Situated Studio

a Situated Studio · Gemma Medina and Minsung Wang

THREE EVENINGS, SIX MODULES

EVENING	FIRST	AFTER THE BREAK
Tue 3 November	My hourly rate	From quote to invoice
Thu 5 November	Project budget	Seeds of Hope pt.1
Tue 10 November	Interdependence	Seeds of Hope pt.2

17.00 to 21.00, Room 2A. Each module takes about 90 minutes.

THE TOOLS AND MATERIALS, ALSO AFTERWARDS

bronvandoen.github.io/tags/economic-cultures

THANKS FOR BEING HERE

HOW WE WORK

This is a safe space to speak your mind; ask any question and make plenty of mistakes.

Respect each other’s time, effort and opinions.

Say hello to unfamiliar faces, we are here to learn from each other.

Please give us your full attention. We keep time quite strictly ☺

We take photos for documentation. Tell us if you’d rather not be in them.

WHY WE'RE HERE

A FLOOR, NOT A PRICE TAG

Your rate is the least an hour of your work needs to earn. The moment it meets a client is where most of us undersell.

Here we practise that moment: the quote, the negotiation, the handshake, the invoice.

BEFORE WE START

A SOFT EXERCISE

We start with something light. On the way, we form the cell groups you work in for this module.

A PROMISE AND A REQUEST

Both	Only the quote	Only the invoice
Your details	Validity	Invoice number
Your client’s details	Your terms	Delivery date
The work, line by line	Acceptance	Due date
Price and VAT		Payment request
		Quote reference

bronvandoen.github.io/tools/economic-cultures/ quote-invoice

WHO YOU ARE

Your client needs to know who they are dealing with, and who to pay.

THE KVK · kvk.nl

A registered business is one a client takes seriously. Today we use practice numbers.

THE IND · ind.nl

From outside the EU? Whether your permit allows self-employment is a question for the IND.

YOUR CLIENT

Meet your client. Who are they, and what do they ask for? Write it down as they tell you.

TALK

“I really like your work.” Get to know your client. What are they willing to tell you up front: the budget, the deadline, who owns the work?

THE INTAKE

Your client asks. You listen, and ask back. No prices yet: find out what they really need.

WHAT AND WHY

The work, what it is for, and who it is for.

WHEN AND HOW MUCH

The deadline, the rounds of changes, the budget.

WHO USES WHAT

Where it will be used, for how long, with whose name on it.

Take notes your own way: by hand, on your phone, or recorded, if your client agrees.

ROUND 1 IS FOR UNDERSTANDING. ROUND 2 IS FOR AGREEING.

THE BRIEF

Write the brief in a way you would both sign. One item per part of the work, one per cost.

PAUSE

What did you forget to ask?

HOW YOU CHARGE

By the hour, or for the finished work? Who carries the risk if it takes longer?

BY THE HOUR

Extra hours are paid. Research often works this way.

A FIXED FEE

Extra hours are yours. Curatorial and commissioned work often comes with a fixed budget.

YOUR PRICE

The items from your brief are here. What is each one worth? Prices without VAT; the tool adds 21%.

PAUSE

Is every hour in this price worth at least your rate? And does it cover the hours nobody sees in this job?

YOUR QUOTE

A few details turn your price into a quote. Agree before you start.

VALIDITY

Protects you, and lets you raise a price later.

PAYMENT TERM

30 days, unless you agree otherwise. 60 at most.

YOUR TERMS

A reference to your general terms.

THE NEGOTIATION

Sit with your client again. Go through the quote line by line, until you both know what you shake hands on.

AS THE CLIENT

Push a little. Ask what each line is for.

Where could it cost less? What would you give up for that?

AS THE DESIGNER

Explain each line. Hold your rate.

Trade the scope, the time or the rounds of changes, not your hours.

“WE LIKE YOUR WORK” OPENS A NEGOTIATION.

THE HANDSHAKE

You agreed, but on what? Change the lines to what you settled on.

A SPOKEN YES IS NOT ENOUGH.

A signed quote, or “I agree” in the same email thread.

YOUR INVOICE

WHAT GOES ON IT

Everything from the quote, plus a number, the delivery date and the due date.

NUMBERING

One series. No gaps, no repeats.

ON TIME

Invoice when you deliver, by the 15th of the next month at the latest.

GETTING PAID

30 days, unless you agreed otherwise. Late? You may charge interest and at least €40 in costs.

INVOICING ON TIME IS YOUR PART. PAYING ON TIME IS THEIRS.

VAT PASSES THROUGH YOU

You add 21% to your invoices and claim back the VAT on your costs. Each quarter you pay the difference.

€210 ADDED TO €1,000 OF INVOICES	−	**€42** PAID ON €200 OF COSTS	=	**€168** PAID TO THE TAX OFFICE

The KOR. Under €20,000 turnover a year: no VAT charged, none claimed back. Apply in advance.

A business client outside the EU. Usually no Dutch VAT. Check that country's rules.

A business client in the EU. No Dutch VAT: write "btw verlegd" and their VAT number.

Timing. VAT is due on what you invoice, also before you are paid.

CHECK AND HAND OVER

Swap phones. Your client checks the invoice against the quote. Then save the PDF or the link.

TO TAKE HOME

- What did your client not tell you, and when and how could you have asked?
- Did you lower your price before anyone asked you to?
- What would you rather have put in your quote than done for free?
- Has a client ever asked you to work for free before a proper assignment?

THE UNSPOKEN RULES

Every negotiation has rules nobody tells you. A newcomer plays without knowing them.

TALK

Where did it feel uncomfortable, and where did you give in?

Which rule did you only learn by breaking it?

Who has a story from a real client?

IF IT GOES WRONG

KUNSTENBOND

The union for culture. Members get legal help and a contract check. Students: first year free.

kunstenbond.nl

BNO

The association of Dutch designers. Members get advice on contracts and terms, and model documents.

bno.nl

JURIDISCH LOKET

Free, on a low income. For freelancers: your personal situation, or self-employed on paper only.

juridischloket.nl

JOIN BEFORE YOU NEED IT.

How do you ask to be paid?

YOU MADE A PROMISE AND ASKED FOR PAYMENT. IN WRITING.



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WE CONCLUDE THIS MODULE

GOOD WORK!

Let’s take a moment to reflect on what just happened.

Tell us what you felt and learned. A few lines are enough.

HOW WAS THIS MODULE?



bronvandoen.github.io/feedback

Tue 3 Nov · Quote to invoice